Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology

Faculty of Computing SLIIT

Employability Readiness – Evidence-Based Reflection

Employability Skills Development (IT 3050)

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1. Evidence-Based Self-Reflection & Lecture Impact Analysis

During my last semester's web development group project, I had a big coding failure. At that time, I had just finished implementing the new feature that was assigned to me. Also, the affected people were mainly our team members and the project supervisor. Before going to my team, I tried to fix the problem myself.

Before I went to my team, I tried to fix the issue myself. So, the website was down, which not only delayed the work but also had an adverse effect on my colleagues. This was a clear indication that my employability readiness level is rather low. My errors are that I lack communication, accountability, and professional discipline.

Self-Rating of Employability Skills

- **Accountability – 2/5**
  Example: I did not inform the team about the issue.

  Risk: This can cause a delay in a company.
- **Communication – 2/5**
  Example: I did not update my team on the system failure.

  Risk: The likelihood is that you could create confusion and/or cause technical difficulties.
- **Teamwork – 3/5**
  Example: I did not work as part of a team; instead, I worked individually; therefore

  Risk: Will impact the performance of a team.
- **Adaptability – 2/5**
  Example: I did not handle unexpected errors well.

  Risk: This can cause a delay in handling real-life issues.
- **Professional Discipline – 2/5**

  Example: I have not updated the computer system or implemented any type of backup plan; therefore

Risk: May cause the system to fail in an actual environment.

Lecture Impact and Reflection

One lecture that really changed the way I thought was the one about Accountability and Communication in challenging situations. The lecturer pointed out that it is very important to clearly explain the problem if a delay or technical issue occurs, take responsibility, and suggest a solution. This made me rethink my previous attitude since I thought that the best way was to manage the problem by myself. Nevertheless, I realize that in a team environment, it is of course much more important to be open and to communicate in advance for the achievement of good results.

To sum up, this experience made me see my faults, and at the same time, it made me realize the significance of one's professional behavior in real-life situations. It highlighted the necessity of good communication, accountability, and the implementation of work habits, such as always maintaining backups. I intend to work on these areas to better my performance and be more prepared in a professional work setting.

Besides this, this lecture also helped me understand that while making errors is a part of the learning process, it is the way one responds to such errors that eventually makes one a professional. Rather than trying to hide errors or trying to solve them on one’s own, it is important to look for support from team members and take corrective actions. This will eventually make me a responsible person while working on academic or professional projects.

2. Industry Alignment & Professional Judgment

Industry Alignment

As an IT undergraduate and backend developer trainee, I read an advertisement for an entry-level position for a Junior Backend Developer in a software development company. This job requires the person applying to have some essential skills.

The main skill that the job demands is back-end programming in Java, Python, and Node.js. I have done back-end programming during my internship and school projects, and also through the creation of REST APIs.I believe I have this skill at a beginning level, but I require more practice.

The second primary skill required is database management with SQL and NoSQL technologies. I have experience using MySQL to store and query data, but I will need additional practice.

The third key skill required for the position was problem-solving and debugging. I can solve basic problems; however, I face difficulties while solving complex problems under a given deadline.

Professional Judgment (Ethical Scenario)

My commitment to ethics, responsibility, and quality assurance means that if I found a major defect with just a couple of days left until the deadline and my TL said to just ignore it, I would call the TL, let him know about the defect, tell him the risks associated with the defect, offer to fix the defect as soon as possible, and offer to inform the stakeholders that the project would be delayed due to this defect.

I have confidence that I will act in a professional manner while under pressure within the professional context and continue to develop my judgment through my experiences.

3. My Immediate Upgrade Plan

Over the course of the following six months, I will be carrying out three distinct actions to expand my employability as a backend developer. First, I will **build two backend applications using Node.js & Python**. Each application will incorporate RESTful APIs and a database to support the application to grow coding skills and develop my ability to integrate backends with frontends. Second, I will continue to **improve my database understanding** by studying advanced MYSQL & MongoDB topics; I will apply these topics to three mini projects to reinforce my learning. Third, I will continue **improving my problem-solving and debugging abilities** by completing daily coding challenges from LeetCode or HackerRank, with an additional 20 medium-level coding problems targeted per month.

All three of these actions are measurable, have a time frame set, and align with my career goals.